

# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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Last week: DJIA 43840.91 ▲ 412.89 0.95% NASDAQ 18847.28 ▼ 3.5% STOXX 600 557.19 ▲ 0.6% 10-YR. TREASURY ▲ 1 17/32, yield 4.228% OIL \$69.76 ▼ \$0.64 EURO \$1.0378 YEN 150.62

## What's News

### Business & Finance

◆ **High domestic prices**, largely unaddressed in Trump's public statements, worry some Republicans aware that a campaign promise to bring relief to consumers could embarrass the president should prices continue to rise. **A1**

◆ **Chinese buyers** are circumventing U.S. export controls to order Nvidia's latest AI chips, illustrating the challenges the Trump administration will face in choking off cutting-edge American technology. **A1**

◆ **Shell is exploring** a potential sale of its chemicals assets in Europe and the U.S., part of a continuing drive to refocus its business on its most-profitable operations. **B3**

◆ **Crypto prices surged** after Trump said he would move forward on a U.S. crypto strategic reserve that will include bitcoin and ether as well as three smaller and riskier tokens. **B1**

◆ **Shares of fast-food chain** Mixue were set to begin trading in Hong Kong on Monday in an initial public offering that follows a blistering expansion of the business from its base in China. **B1**

◆ **Investors anticipating** the imposition of Trump's tariffs are ditching risky corners of the stock market for areas perceived as more insulated from the president's trade salvos. **B1**

◆ **Mondelez, a maker of** glow-in-the-dark confections, plans to begin selling at least two of the products in the U.S. online and in stores this month. **B3**

◆ **KPMG began to set up** a law firm in the U.S. after a court decision made it the first of the Big Four accounting firms eligible to practice law in the country. **B9**

### World-Wide

◆ **European allies led by** the U.K. and France will work with Ukraine to try to forge a peace plan that they would present to Trump after a public clash between the U.S. and Ukrainian presidents at the White House on Friday. **A1, A7**

◆ **Ukrainian President** Volodymyr Zelensky took half steps over the weekend to repair the damage done in the blowup, but offered no apology, a portent of the difficulties ahead for him in Washington. **A6**

◆ **Israel said it was** stopping any entry of goods into the Gaza Strip after a 42-day cease-fire expired a day earlier without any agreement with Hamas on what comes next. **A1**

◆ **A budget fight brewing** in Congress is becoming the first test of whether lawmakers will try to claw back the powers they ceded willy-nilly to Trump in the first weeks of his second term. **A4**

◆ **Some of the biggest** U.S. consulting firms are meeting with Trump administration officials to defend their projects ahead of a deadline for government agencies to justify major consulting contracts. **A4**

◆ **Former Gov. Andrew** Cuomo, who resigned in disgrace three years ago, announced his return to politics with a bid to become New York City's next mayor. **A3**

◆ **Iran's parliament** impeached the country's finance minister and voted to dismiss him amid accusations of mismanagement and a steep depreciation of the national currency. **A7**

◆ **A private lunar lander** carrying tools and experiments for NASA touched down on the moon on Sunday. **A5**

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CHRIS J. RATCLIFFE/PRESS POOL

Ukraine President Volodymyr Zelensky arrives for a European meeting in London on forging a peace accord in Ukraine.

## European Allies Seek to Forge Their Own Ukraine Peace Plan

U.K., France look to repair diplomatic damage after Trump outburst at Zelensky

LONDON—The U.K. and France said they would lead a European effort to forge a Ukraine peace plan to present

By Max Colchester, Laurence Norman and Ian Lovett

to President Trump, as they sought to patch up differences between Kyiv and Washington following Friday's White

House clash.

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer hosted nearly 20 allies in London on Sunday and said progress had been made in building a "coalition of the willing," which would commit military assets, including troops on the ground, to secure any eventual peace. He said more countries would need to come on board if Europe is to build a force that would deter Russian aggression in Ukraine.

"Through my discussions over recent days, we've agreed that the U.K., France and others will work with Ukraine on a plan to stop the

fighting, then we'll discuss that plan with the United States," Starmer said, adding that he had spoken with Trump about his intentions.

Friday's White House meeting between Trump and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, in which the U.S. president berated the Ukrainian leader during an extraordinary on-camera exchange, triggered frantic diplomacy among European allies as they both sought to display support for Ukraine while finding a way to ensure the U.S. doesn't turn its back on Kyiv.

After the meeting, Trump said on his Truth Social plat-

form that he had determined Zelensky wasn't ready for peace if America was involved, because that gave Ukraine an advantage, reducing its incentive to make concessions.

European officials hope to bring Washington, Europe and Ukraine to a shared stance on the conditions for ending the war that they can use as the

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◆ **Zelensky offers gratitude, no apology.....** A6  
◆ **Years of war leave Ukrainians weary.....** A6  
◆ **Vance defends Trump's Ukraine strategy.....** A7

## Israel Halts Aid To Gaza As Talks Falter

Hamas rejects plan to extend cease-fire that would have freed more hostages

By Dov Lieber

TEL AVIV—Israel on Sunday said it was stopping any entry of goods into the Gaza Strip after a 42-day cease-fire expired a day earlier without any agreement with Hamas on what comes next.

Hours before the cease-fire eclipsed, Israel said it agreed to a proposal by the Trump administration's Mideast envoy, Steve Witkoff, to continue the truce and that Hamas had rejected it.

The proposal would see half of the 58 hostages still held in Gaza released on the first day and give both sides until mid-April to negotiate a permanent cease-fire under the same conditions as the previous 42 days. If successful, the rest of the hostages would be released on the final day of the extended period.

Hamas said Israel was using its control over aid to Gaza to force it into a new agreement rather than allowing Hamas to have a say.

Under the original agreement, the second phase would include the release of all living hostages held by Hamas while Israel was meant to fully withdraw from Gaza and commit to a permanent cease-fire. But those negotiations never got off the ground during the first phase of the cease-fire, leaving the second phase in limbo.

"With the conclusion of the first stage of the hostages deal

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◆ **Oct. 7 attack marked a familiar spying failure....** A8

## Some in GOP Get Nervous As Prices Stay High

WASHINGTON—President Trump promised during the campaign to lower prices on day one of his presidency. But with costs still high, Republicans are worried the economic factors that helped Trump win the election could come back to bite him if inflation remains stubborn.

By Tarini Parti, Xavier Martinez and Josh Dawsey

In public appearances and social-media posts, Trump is more likely to talk about federal workers, diversity programs and foreign policy than the price of eggs. Trump, urged by his advisers, last year made high costs a centerpiece of his bid to retake the White House.

Republicans, who still pin the blame on Trump's predecessor, say voters have been willing to give Trump some leeway to enact his agenda—but they warn that goodwill might not last.

"I'm nervous about it," said Stephen Moore, a veteran outside adviser to Trump on economic issues. "The Trump administration needs to keep its eye on what's happening with prices. It should be a top priority. The trend is a little bit troubling."

Further compounding the political risks: Trump's far-reaching plans to impose stiff tariffs on foreign imports could drive up prices further, according to economists.

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## 'Anora' Dominates Oscars



PATRICK T. FALLON/AP/GETTY IMAGES

**BIG WINNER: 'Anora,' starring Mikey Madison, left, received the award for best picture on Sunday at the 97th Academy Awards in Los Angeles. The film, about a New York sex worker, also received awards for best actress, best director, best original screenplay and best film editing. A12**

## 'Garage Mahals' Are Driving Neighbors Nuts

When a regular garage isn't big enough, Minnesotans turn to luxury storage spaces

By Joe Barrett

CHANHASSEN, Minn.—With his three-car garage in this Minneapolis suburb already full, Bret Bailey had to keep his racing Porsche in a trailer outside through brutal Minnesota winters.

Then one March, as he prepared for a race, Bailey discovered the wheels of the trailer had frozen to the ground.

"For two weeks, I'm throwing salt out there," said the 64-year-old retired IT manager.

Now, Bailey is part of a man-cave-meets-Storage Wars

revolution spreading across the country.

He keeps his two Porsches, Ferrari, custom Harley, dune buggy and racing trailer in a nearly 2,700-square-foot space outfitted like a sleek European car dealership. It sports a tequila bar, heated floors, bathroom with a shower, giant TV, leather sofa, stack of racing tires and a car lift. He's among 100 owners in a complex of garage condos called Chanhasseen AutoPlex whose car shows attract thousands of people on summer weekends.

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Where to park it?

## Schools Revive Shop Class

Hands-on skills stage comeback, driven by college costs, demand for choices

By Te-Ping Chen

In America's most surprising cutting-edge classes, students pursue hands-on work with wood, metals and machinery, getting a jump on lucrative old-school careers.

School districts around the U.S. are spending tens of millions of dollars to expand and revamp high-school shop classes for the 21st century. They are betting on the future of manual skills overlooked in the digital age,

offering vocational-education classes that school officials say give students a broader view of career prospects with or without college. With higher-education costs soaring and white-collar workers under threat by generative AI, the timing couldn't be better.

In a suburb of Madison, Wis., Middleton High School completed a \$90 million campus overhaul in 2022 that included new technical-education facilities. The

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## Nvidia AI Chips Reach China Despite U.S. Ban

By Raffaele Huang and Liza Lin

Chinese buyers are circumventing U.S. export controls to order Nvidia's latest artificial-intelligence chips, illustrating the challenges the Trump administration will face in choking off cutting-edge American technology.

Traders in the country are selling computing systems with Nvidia's Blackwell chips installed by routing them through third parties in nearby regions. Some sellers promise buyers delivery within six weeks.

The transactions are the latest example of how U.S. restrictions barring China from buying high-end AI processors have failed to stop the trade. Since 2022, Washington has

imposed export controls to curb China's access to semiconductors for training and powering state-of-the-art AI, but an underground network of brokers has sprung up to get around the controls.

What to do about the gray-market activity is a challenge for the Trump administration, which is weighing how to manage the technological rivalry with China.

Beijing is promoting AI development, and the recent frenzy surrounding Chinese AI developer DeepSeek has prompted local companies to deploy the technology more widely.

James Luo, a vendor in the Chinese tech hub of Shenzhen, said he received an order for more than a dozen Blackwell

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